Stefan Herytash

sherytash.github.io

October 2026

Teaching Portfolio

Assistant Professor, WU Vienna
Application for the Tenure Track Assistant Professorship in Digital Marketing, Department of Marketing, Copenhagen Business School

PART A

Reflections on strengths and aspirations

Core strengths

TEACHING PHILOSOPHY

Students remember what they built. My courses are organized around artifacts: a working analysis, an agent that does something. Lectures exist to unblock the building. I plan the destination precisely and the route loosely, because the most useful minutes in a session usually start with a student objection I did not script.

I have taught with language models since the LMU seminar on AI in marketing in 2024. My stance has not moved since: treat the model as an object of study and as an instrument at the same time, and hold student work to the standard of what the instrument now makes cheap. In marketing this stance has a direct use. A language model can now draft a questionnaire and answer it in place of respondents; my research measures when such simulated respondents reproduce the results of real experiments and when they do not. Students who learn the tools without that test learn to trust them too much.

PAST TEACHING AND ITS IMPACT ON STUDENTS

I taught at LMU Munich from 2022 to 2025 and have taught at WU Vienna since 2026, with one course at EM Lyon Business School in January 2023. At LMU most of my teaching was in the bachelor's programme in business administration: exercise sessions in *Marketing Management*, *Project Management*, the main seminar of the Institute for Market-Based Management (on AI in marketing in 2024 and 2025) and a project course with BavariaDirekt as industry partner. At WU I teach *Strategy and Innovation*, the course *Agentic AI in Strategy & Innovation*, which I designed, two sessions on AI in the *Vienna Innovation Program* for North American MBA students, and the master's *Business Project* with Vienna Airport as corporate partner. I have supervised more than fifteen bachelor's and master's theses at LMU and WU, and at WU I run my own thesis track, *Applied AI in Strategy & Innovation*. Part B lists every course with term and role.

Agentic AI in Strategy & Innovation, now in its second run, is the clearest case of how I teach. Over five sessions students build a working agent in Python against a hosted model API. They work through five building blocks, each adding one capability: a single model call, the agent loop, tool use, structured output, and reliability under failure. By the third session students are designing the tool interfaces the model has to reason about, and deciding what the agent should remember between runs. By the fourth they write a small evaluation harness that re-runs fixed cases after every change, and they work through the failure modes ordinary software does not have, from runaway loops to prompt injection. I set the two readings against each other on purpose: one on what agents promise, one on an eight-month field study in which the technology intensified work instead of reducing it.

Five teams shipped working agents in the first run. One books calendar events and drafts a morning briefing, one lists and buys on a second-hand marketplace, one finds and compares supplier deals, one searches and filters flat listings, one plans training. The demo does not earn the grade. I ask whether a human stands in front of the consequential action, whether untrusted input can hijack the agent, what the memory is for, and what a single run costs. The course is open book and students are told to use AI on their own work, which is why every team has to defend what it submitted. In the evaluation, 95 % of the students recommend the course. Their written comments, which follow in the appendix, return to one point: they built something themselves.

Evaluations at LMU tell the same story with a different instrument. Students rated how strongly they would recommend me as instructor on a scale from 0 to 10. In the *Marketing Management* exercise sessions of summer 2025 the mean was 9 out of 10, with a Net Promoter Score of +71; in *Project*

Management in winter 2023/24 it was 10 out of 10, with a Net Promoter Score of +100. In the *Vienna Innovation Program*, in which I taught the AI sessions, 100 % of the students recommend the programme.

WU VIENNA *Would you recommend this course?*

Agentic AI in Strategy & Innovation — 95% recommend
Summer 2026

Vienna Innovation Program — 100% recommend
Summer 2026

LMU MUNICH *Would you recommend the instructor?* 0 to 10

Marketing Management — 9 out of 10
Summer 2025
Net Promoter Score +71
promoters · passives · detractors

Project Management — 10 out of 10
Winter 2023
Net Promoter Score +100
promoters · passives · detractors

Three comments from the *Marketing Management* exercise sessions (LMU, summer 2025, translated from German) describe what students took from the sessions:

> *"Practice-oriented, capable teaching staff advocates convincingly for the field addressed. In particular, Mr. Herytash is to be highlighted for his outstanding abilities to respond spontaneously to contributions and to adapt the teaching to them. He promotes participation and builds a good teaching-learning relationship."*
>
> („Praxisnah, fähiges Lehrpersonal tritt überzeugend für das behandelte Feld ein. Insbesondere Herr Herytash ist mit seinen herausragenden Fähigkeiten spontan auf Beiträge einzugehen und die Lehre darauf anzupassen hervorzuheben. Er fördert Mitarbeit und baut ein gutes Lehr-Lern Verhältnis auf!")
>
> Marketing Management · LMU Munich · 2025

> *"Overall, the course gave me great enjoyment, mainly thanks to Stefan. He always kept the exercises very interactive and at the same time conveyed the subject matter very vividly."*
>
> („Insgesamt hat mir der Kurs großen Spaß bereitet, maßgeblich durch Stefan. Er hat die Übungen stets sehr interaktiv gehalten und gleichzeitig den Lehrstoff sehr anschaulich rübergebracht.")
>
> Marketing Management · LMU Munich · 2025

> *"I liked very much that Mr. Herytash's exercises were designed to be very interactive and creative, and that one could take a great deal away from them. He also always managed to bring fairly theoretical topics closer to us in a very simple way."*
>
> („Mir hat es sehr gefallen, dass die Übungen von Herrn Herytash sehr interaktiv und kreativ gestaltet wurden und man sehr viel mitnehmen konnte. Außerdem hat er es immer geschafft relativ theoretische Themen uns sehr einfach näher zu bringen.")
>
> Marketing Management · LMU Munich · 2025

PEDAGOGICAL REFLECTIONS

My strength is the live part of teaching: taking up a contribution and turning it into the next step. The comments above say so, and so did students in small project groups at LMU, who named close supervision as what they valued most.

Competencies to develop

My weak point is the written frame around open formats. In the first run of the agentic AI course, the items with the lowest agreement were whether the objectives were clear from the beginning (71 %) and whether the performance requirements were appropriate (75 %); 81 % said they were familiar with the assessment criteria. In the *Vienna Innovation Program* a student wrote that the teams had no grading rubric for the final presentation. In the LMU seminar of 2025, students asked for a date for each work step and for clearer formal guidelines at the start. The pattern is consistent. When students choose their own project, the freedom they praise in the comments costs them orientation, and the syllabus has to carry what my presence in the room cannot. The conclusion I draw is to treat the rubric as part of the assignment, handed out with the task, and to set a date for each work step in project courses so that a team learns early whether it is on track.

Generative AI changes what assessment has to measure. If students may use a model on their work, a polished deliverable shows little; the defence of it shows more. In my courses each team explains its

design choices and the failure cases it tested, and the grade rests on that judgement. Marketing students need the same discipline with synthetic data: an analysis built on simulated respondents is only as good as the check against real ones, and a course on these methods should grade whether students ran that check.

CBS's Higher Education Teaching Excellence Programme (HETEP) is the path I would take in my first two years. It pairs a supervisor from the Department of Marketing with one from another department, includes at least five observed teaching sessions and four collaborative inquiry workshops with written assignments, and ends with an Account of Professional Practice assessed by a panel. The programme is accredited by Advance HE, and completing it leads to Fellowship of the Higher Education Academy.

I want to use HETEP for two competencies in particular. The first is assessment design: rubrics that make open project work gradable in a way students can anticipate, and oral examination, where the departmental supervisor observes a summative assessment. The second is teaching larger cohorts and online formats; CBS runs online electives for up to two hundred students, while my classes have been seminar-sized. The interaction students value in my sessions has to work at that scale too, and I want feedback from colleagues who have made it work.

CBS teaches in Danish and English, and over time I want to teach in Danish as well. I will learn the language after moving to Copenhagen, and I am eager to.

Teaching opportunities to pursue

At CBS, artificial intelligence in marketing is taught as an applied bachelor's online elective and as a three-ECTS summer course; the bachelor's elective states that it does not cover how AI tools work. *Brand Analytics* in the cand.merc. EMF already includes generative AI for market-research data. A full master's elective on generative AI as a marketing research method would sit one level above the applied courses and next to *Brand Analytics*: students would run simulated respondents against a real survey, measure where the two diverge, and use language models in the design and analysis of their own studies, with agentic workflows as the final step. The course would draw on my research on simulated behavioural experiments and on SimuLabs, the open-source engine I develop for it. I would plan it with the colleagues who teach these courses so that the courses form a sequence.

In the longer run I would like to contribute to the new MSc in Artificial Intelligence for Business, planned to start in summer 2027, and to the Cand.merc. in Advanced Strategic Marketing, with its first intake expected in 2029. I will teach general marketing at bachelor's level again, as I did in the *Marketing Management* exercise sessions at LMU and in *Analyzing Markets* at EM Lyon, and project courses with partner firms in the format of my courses with BavariaDirekt and Vienna Airport. I would also like to teach executives. At WU I teach the AI sessions of the *Vienna Innovation Program*, an executive-level programme for North American Master of Business Administration students, and I would like to bring that format to CBS's executive programmes. Master's theses in the EMF and GMA programmes on AI in marketing research would follow from the elective.

PART B

Overview of experiences, 2023 to 2026

Tab 1: Teaching and Supervision

LMU and WU teach in winter and summer semesters. Evaluation figures are the instructor or course recommendation as stated on my CV; the two WU reports with the students' comments are in the appendix, and the LMU reports are available on request. Programme or level is given where the course record states it.

WU VIENNA

Winter 2026/27	*Agentic AI in Strategy & Innovation*, second run Instructor; own design · not yet evaluated
Winter 2026/27	*Business Project*, corporate partner Vienna Airport MSc Strategy, Innovation and Management Control · Instructor, with Christopher Lettl · not yet evaluated
Summer 2026	*Agentic AI in Strategy & Innovation*, first run Instructor; own design · 95 % recommend (appendix, evaluation 1)
Summer 2026	*Vienna Innovation Program* (Spring Program), two sessions on AI Executive-level programme for North American MBA students · Instructor, with Christopher Lettl · 100 % recommend the programme (appendix, evaluation 2)
Summer 2026	*Strategy and Innovation* Instructor
2026 –	Thesis track *Applied AI in Strategy & Innovation*; bachelor's and master's theses BSc, MSc · Supervisor

LMU MUNICH

Summer 2025	*Marketing Management*, exercise sessions BSc · Teaching Assistant · instructor 9 out of 10, Net Promoter Score +71
Summer 2024, Summer 2025	*Seminar on AI in Marketing* BSc Business Administration · Instructor, in a teaching team
Summer 2023, 2024, 2025	*Project Course in Management*, industry partner BavariaDirekt Supervisor
Winter 2024/25	*Mathematics Preparatory Course* Instructor
Winter 2023/24, Winter 2024/25	*Project Management* BSc Business Administration · Instructor · instructor 10 out of 10, Net Promoter Score +100 (winter 2023/24)
Winter 2023/24, Summer 2024	*Graduate Management Admission Test Preparatory Course* Coordinator
Summer 2023	*Main Seminar in Market-Oriented Management* BSc Business Administration · Instructor, in a teaching team
Summer 2023	*Advanced Public Relations* Coordinator
Summer 2023	*Marketing Management*, exercise sessions BSc · Teaching Assistant
2022 – 2025	Bachelor's and master's theses BSc, MSc · Supervisor

EM LYON BUSINESS SCHOOL

January 2023	*Analyzing Markets* Instructor

In total I have supervised more than fifteen bachelor's and master's theses at LMU Munich and WU Vienna.

Tab 2: Continuous Professional Development

2025	**Doctoral Summer School on AI** League of European Research Universities, University of Copenhagen; selected participant, with a competitive LMU stipend
2025	**Excellence Mentoring Stipend** LMU Munich School of Management, awarded on competitive application
2026	Designed *Agentic AI in Strategy & Innovation* at WU Vienna (first run summer 2026)

Tab 3: Roles and Responsibilities

2026 – 2027	Member of the appointment committee for the Full Professor of Strategic Management, WU Vienna
2026 –	Thesis track *Applied AI in Strategy & Innovation*, WU Vienna: own call for theses
2023 – 2024	Coordinator, *Graduate Management Admission Test Preparatory Course*, LMU Munich
2022 – 2023	Coordinator, *Advanced Public Relations*, LMU Munich

Appendix: the two most recent student evaluations

The appendix holds the official WU Vienna evaluation reports of summer 2026, each followed by the students' written comments, two report pages to a sheet. The report pages are drawn graphics; the comments are scans of handwritten answers.

1. *Agentic AI in Strategy & Innovation*, WU Vienna, summer 2026: evaluation report (4 pages) and the answers to "What I especially liked about the course" (5 pages). The export holds no answers to the improvement question.
2. *Vienna Innovation Program*, WU Vienna, summer 2026: evaluation report (5 pages; it rates the whole programme) and the answers to "What I especially liked about the course" (3 pages) and "What I feel could be improved" (3 pages).

The evaluation reports were submitted with the application and are not part of this copy.